C-F-151a

JULY 24, 1940

SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. C-F-151
February 6, 1934

FEDERAL STANDARD STOCK CATALOG

Section IV

(Part 5)

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FOR

FEATHERS

This specification was approved on the above date by the Director of Procurement, for the use of all departments and establishments of the Government, and shall become effective not later than March 1, 1941. It may be put into effect, however, at any earlier date after promulgation.

A. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATION.

A–1. There are no other Federal Specifications applicable to this specification.

B. GRADE AND TYPES

B–1. Feathers shall be of but one grade, and of the following types as specified in the invitation for bids:

Type I. Chicken.
Type II. Duck.
Type III. Goose.

C. MATERIAL AND WORKMANSHIP.

C–1. *Material.*—Shall be new (not used) feathers.

C–2. *Workmanship.*—The feathers shall be well dusted, washed, dried, and sterilized.

D. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS.

D–1. *Odor.*—The feathers shall have no objectionable odor.

D–2. *Brittleness.*—The feathers shall be sufficiently pliable to permit the ends to be brought together without breaking the quill.

D–3. *Damaged feathers.*—Damaged feathers, that is, those broken, damaged by insects, or damaged in any manner, other than that caused by the process of curling or crushing of chicken feathers, shall not exceed 5 percent.

D–4. *Cleanness.*—Feathers shall be clean when tested by the method in paragraph F–2.

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E. DETAIL REQUIREMENTS.

E-1. *Chicken feathers.*—Shall be curled or crushed, that is, treated to impart a gentle curve to the feathers, but shall not be chopped or stripped. Feathers shall show no more pith than is natural to the curling operation. The use of wing and tail quills longer than 4 inches shall not exceed 3 percent by weight.

E-2. *Duck feathers.*—Shall contain not less than 10 percent of natural down. The average length of the feathers shall not exceed 3 inches. Feathers longer than 4 inches together with feathers other than duck feathers shall total not more than 3 percent.

E-3. *Goose feathers.*—Shall contain not less than 10 percent of natural down. The average length of the feathers shall not exceed 3 inches. Feathers longer than 4 inches together with feathers other than goose feathers shall total not more than 3 percent.

F. METHODS OF SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TESTS.

F-1. *Sampling.*—

F-1a. Samples shall be taken at random from deliveries to determine compliance with this specification. Not less than 1 pound from each 100 pounds or fraction thereof of bulk feathers and 1 or more pillows from each lot of 100 pillows or fraction thereof.

F-1b. A sample of not less than 5 grams made up of small specimens taken from different parts of the sample shall be used for determining percentage of damaged feathers (see paragraph D-3), for percentage of down, of feathers longer than 4 inches, and of feathers not specified (see paragraphs E-2 and E-3). If this sample fails to meet the requirements of the specification, two more samples shall be taken in the same way and tested. The results for the three samples shall be averaged. Failure of the average result to comply with the requirements herein shall be cause for rejection of the lot represented by the sample.

F-2. *Cleanness test—chicken, duck, and goose feathers.*—Cleanness shall be determined by immersing 30 grams (approximately 1 ounce) of feathers in 2 liters of distilled water for 2 hours. The mass shall be agitated thoroughly to separate dirt and impurities from the feathers. The suspension shall be strained through a piece of clean muslin to remove the feathers and feather particles. The wash water shall be allowed to stand for 72 hours in an open container at a temperature of 70 to 75° F. Marked cloudiness of the solution indicates dirt in the feathers. Increased cloudiness on standing, development of an offensive odor, or frothing are evidence of decomposition and will be considered as failure to meet specification requirements.

G. PACKAGING, PACKING, AND MARKING FOR SHIPMENT.

G-1. *Packaging.*—Commercial packaging is acceptable under this specification. Feathers shall be protected from foreign matter and moisture. Each package shall contain 50 to 75 pounds of feathers.

G-2. *Packing.*—Unless otherwise specified, the subject commodity shall be delivered in standard commercial containers so constructed as to insure acceptance by common or other carrier for safe transportation, at the lowest rate, to the point of delivery.

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G–3. *Marking.*—Unless otherwise specified, shipping containers shall be marked with the name of the article, the kind, and the quantity contained therein, as defined by the contract or order under which shipment is made, the name of contractor, and the number of the contract or order.

H. REQUIREMENTS APPLICABLE TO INDIVIDUAL DEPARTMENTS.

H–1. *Specifications.*—The following requirements and departmental specifications of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, shall form a part of this specification.

H–2. *Navy Department.*—Navy Department General Specifications for Inspection of Material, copies of which may be obtained, without cost, upon application to the Bureau of Supplies and accounts, Navy Department, Washington, D. C., except that naval activities should make application to the Commandant, Navy Yard, New York, N. Y.

H–2a. *Navy Department purchases—standard sample.*—In all respects not specifically covered by this specification, the feathers shall be equal to the standard sample, which may be seen upon application to any of the following, or a portion of which may be obtained from the Commandant, Navy Yard, New York, N. Y., or the Commandant, Navy Yard, Mare Island, Calif.

(1) Commandant, Navy Yard:
New York, N. Y.
Philadelphia, Pa.
Norfolk, Va.
Mare Island, Calif.
Puget Sound, Wash.

(2) Inspector of Naval Material, United States Navy:
Boston, Mass.
Hartford, Conn.
Cincinnati, Ohio.
Chicago, Ill.
San Francisco, Calif.
Seattle, Wash.
Atlanta District, Atlanta, Ga.

(3) Naval Medical Supply Depot, Brooklyn, N. Y.
Naval clothing depot, Brooklyn, N. Y.

H–3. *War Department.*—United States Army No. 100–2 "Standard Specifications for Marking Shipments," insofar as the terms are applicable (copies of which may be obtained upon application to the Quartermaster General, War Department, Washington, D. C.)

H–3a. *United States Army Purchases.*—

H–3a(1). For domestic shipment, current commercial practice which will insure delivery at destination in good order shall be followed; for export, United States Army Specifications for export packing, current on date of invitation for bids, shall be followed.

H–3a(2). Shipments shall be marked as specified in United States Army Specifications No. 100–2.

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I. NOTES.

I–1. Purchasing officers should specify the type of feathers required and may require the contractor to furnish an affidavit to show that feathers supplied are new and not used, and have been properly sterilized.

I–2. It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

I–3. This specification covers only the types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodity as generally purchased by the Federal Government, and is not intended to include all of the types, etc., which are commercially available.

I–4. An index of Federal specifications may be obtained upon application as noted in paragraph below, price to be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.

I–5. Copies of this specification may be obtained upon application, accompanied by money order, or coupon, or cash, to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. Price 5 cents.

Notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

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